Silvies Club
Calendar Reservation System

Member Guide

Website: silviesclub.pythonanywhere.com

This guide covers how to navigate the reservation website and explains the lottery draft rules for the annual cabin booking season.

Table of Contents

1. Getting Started — Logging In
2. Your Dashboard
3. The Calendar View
4. Making a Reservation
5. Account Settings
6. Understanding the Calendar Year
7. The Lottery Draft — How It Works
8. Key Reservation Rules
9. Frequently Asked Questions

1. Getting Started — Logging In

Open your web browser and go to **silviesclub.pythonanywhere.com**. You will see the login screen.

[Screenshot: Login Page — showing Email and Password fields, Log In button, and Forgot Password link]

Enter the **email address** and **password** that were provided to you by the club administrator (Spike). Click **Log In** to access the system.

If you have forgotten your password, click the **"Forgot your password?"** link below the Log In button. You will receive a password reset email at the address on file.

Tip: Check the "Remember Me" box to stay logged in on your personal device.

2. Your Dashboard

After logging in, you land on your **Dashboard**. This is your home base.

[Screenshot: Dashboard — showing season info, Pick Your Dates button, and My Reservations panel]

The Dashboard shows:

- **Current Season** — the year and which phase the lottery is currently in (e.g., SETUP, PHASE1_DRAFT, OPEN_FCFS).
- **Season Dates** — the date range for the current booking season.
- **Pick Your Dates** button — takes you directly to the reservation form.
- **My Reservations** — a list of all your current reservations with the ability to cancel.
- **View Full Calendar** — opens the 12-month calendar view.

Navigation Bar: The top menu bar includes links to **Dashboard**, **Calendar**, **Settings**, and **Log Out**. These are available on every page.

3. The Calendar View

Click **Calendar** in the top navigation to see the full 12-month season calendar.

[Screenshot: Calendar View — showing color-coded months with legend for Open Booking, Lottery, Hunting Season, Reserved, and Blocked dates]

The calendar is **color-coded** so you can see at a glance what's available:

Color	Meaning
Green background	Open Booking — available to reserve anytime
Amber/Yellow border	Lottery (Draft) — controlled by the lottery system
Gray background	Hunting Season — not available for reservation
Dark olive highlight	Reserved — already booked by a member
Red/Coral highlight	Blocked — blocked by admin (e.g., Annual Meeting)

Each month shows its booking zone label (e.g., "Open Booking" or "Lottery") next to the month name. Click the **Reserve Dates** button in the top-right corner to make a new reservation.

4. Making a Reservation

Click **Reserve Dates** (from the Calendar) or **Pick Your Dates** (from the Dashboard) to open the reservation form.

[Screenshot: Reservation Form — showing Start Date, End Date, Notes fields, Confirm Reservation button, and Mini Calendar on the right]

To make a reservation:

- **Start Date** — select your arrival date. You can also click a date on the mini calendar on the right to auto-fill this field.
- **End Date** — select your departure date. Maximum stay is **7 days**.
- **Notes** — optionally add a short note (up to 60 characters), such as "Arriving Friday evening."
- Click **Confirm Reservation** to submit.

The mini calendar on the right side scrolls with you and shows which dates are available, reserved, or blocked — use it as a quick reference while filling out the form.

During lottery draft phases: Your reservation will be marked as **tentative** until you click **"Lock In"** on your Dashboard. You must lock in your pick before your deadline expires (see Section 7).

Cancelling: You can cancel any reservation at any time from your Dashboard. During Phase 2 (First Come First Served), cancelling frees your slot so you can rebook if the phase is still open.

5. Account Settings

Click **Settings** in the navigation bar to update your account information.

[Screenshot: Account Settings — showing Name (read-only), Email, Phone, and Password change fields]

From Settings you can:

- Update your **email address**.
- Update your **phone number**.
- Change your **password** (enter the new password and confirm it).

Your current password is required to save any changes. Your name can only be changed by the admin.

6. Understanding the Calendar Year

The booking year is divided into three zones:

Zone	Dates	How It Works
Open Booking	Jan 1 – Mar 31 and December	Any active member can reserve anytime. No lottery rules apply.
Lottery Period	Apr 1 – Aug 7	Reservations are controlled by the multi-phase lottery draft (see Section 7).
Hunting Season	Aug 8 – Nov 30	The cabin is open for hunting. No reservations needed or allowed.

7. The Lottery Draft — How It Works

The lottery controls who gets to pick dates during the high-demand period (April 1 through August 7). The process moves through several phases, managed by the club administrator (Spike).

Phase 1: Opt-In

When the season opens, you will be asked to **opt in** to the lottery. This is your declaration that you want to participate in the draft. If you do not opt in, you will still be able to reserve lottery dates during Phase 2.

Phase 1: Draft

After opt-in closes, Spike runs the draw. All opted-in members are placed in a **random order**. Members then pick one at a time, in that order.

- When it is your turn, you have **5 days** to select your dates and **lock in** your pick.
- Your reservation starts as **tentative**. Go to your Dashboard and click **"Lock In"** to finalize it.
- If you do not pick or lock in by your deadline, you are **automatically skipped** (or auto-locked if you made a tentative pick).

Phase 2: First Come, First Served

Members who did **not** enter the draw get a chance to reserve one lottery-period slot on a first-come, first-served basis. If you cancel your Phase 2 reservation, you may rebook while the phase is still open.

Phase 3: Reverse Draft

The same members from Phase 1 pick again, but in **reverse order** — the last person to pick in Phase 1 goes first. You have **3 days** to pick and lock in. Same tentative/lock-in rules apply.

Open First Come, First Served

After the draft rounds are complete, all remaining lottery dates open up to **everyone** with no restrictions beyond overlap checking.

8. Key Reservation Rules

Maximum Stay: 7 days per reservation.

Friday–Thursday Block Rule (Phases 1 & 2 only):

During lottery draft phases, the calendar is divided into Friday-through-Thursday blocks. Your reservation can **start on any day** within a block, but it must **end by the Thursday** of that block. This ensures the cabin is clear for the next member arriving on Friday.

> *Example: If you start your stay on a Monday, you must check out by the following Thursday (4-day stay). If you start on Friday, you can stay through the following Thursday (7-day max).*

No Double Booking: The system will not allow overlapping reservations. If your requested dates conflict with an existing booking, you will be asked to choose different dates.

Blocked Dates: Some dates may be blocked by the admin for club events (e.g., the Annual Meeting). These appear in red/coral on the calendar and cannot be reserved.

Lock-In Required: During draft phases (1 and 3), after you select your dates, you must go to your Dashboard and click **"Lock In"** to finalize. Until you lock in, your reservation is tentative and the draft cannot advance to the next member.

Cancellation: You may cancel any reservation at any time from your Dashboard.

9. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if I miss my turn in the draft?

A: If your deadline expires without picking or locking in, you are automatically skipped. You can still reserve dates during the Open FCFS phase later.

Q: Can I change my reservation after locking in?

A: You can cancel your reservation at any time. However, during draft phases, your cancelled dates become available to other members and there is no guarantee you can rebook the same dates.

Q: I forgot my password — what do I do?

A: Click "Forgot your password?" on the login page. A reset link will be sent to the email address on your account.

Q: Can I reserve dates during hunting season?

A: No. August 8 through November 30 is reserved for hunting and is not managed through this system.

Q: What are "Open Booking" dates?

A: January through March and December are always open. Any active member can reserve these dates at any time, regardless of the lottery phase.

Q: Who do I contact if I have a problem?

A: Reach out to the club administrator (Spike) for any issues with your account, the lottery, or reservations.